

Build a talk like software

manim-presentation-pipeline

2026-10-01

4:45 spoken at normal pace (135 wpm)

ACT 1: THE PROBLEM

B0 TITLE CARD (0:00-0:00)

1 (B0.1): "Build a talk like software" [before the talk starts]

(No narration: this is up while the room settles.)

B1 MOTION IS EXPENSIVE (0:00-0:35)

2 (B1.1): "An animated talk shows what slides can't." [click on "An animated talk"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

An animated talk shows what slides can't, and it's expensive to change.

When an idea is a process, motion carries it. A queue fills up. A cache warms. The room watches it happen instead of reading about it.

3 (B1.2): "Every change to an animation is code and a render." [click on "every frame of that is code"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

But every frame of that is code. And every change means rendering it again. A word you'd fix in a second on a slide becomes a scene to rewrite.

B2 NOTES ARRIVE LATE (0:35-1:15)

4 (B2.1): "The same note costs more the later it lands." [click on "Most notes arrive"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

Most notes arrive when the deck is built, and that's where every change costs a render. Think about where a note can land. On a one-page outline, moving a section costs a line. In a script, changing a word costs a word. In a finished deck, the same note costs a scene and a render.

5 (B2.2): "Most notes land at the expensive end." [click on "that's where most notes arrive"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

And that's where most notes arrive.
It's the first time anyone sees the
talk. So the feedback comes in at
the expensive end.

ACT 2: THE PIPELINE

B3 CHECK WHERE IT'S CHEAP (1:15-1:50)

6 (B3.1): "Check each decision where it's cheapest to
change." [click on "So check each decision"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

**So check each decision where it's
cheapest to change.** That's the whole
idea. Split the work into stages.

7 (B3.2): "Each stage ends with something short for the
author." [click on "End each one"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

End each one with something short
the author can check in a few
minutes. The story, on one page. The
words, read aloud. The pictures, as
rough grey boxes. Agents do the
work. The author decides, and
nothing moves on until they do.

B4 PEAK 1: ONE SENTENCE, EVERY STAGE (1:50-3:00)

8 (B4.1): "One sentence changes form at every stage." [click
on "Follow one sentence"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

**Follow one sentence through the
pipeline, and it changes form at
every stage.** Here's a sentence from
a talk about a cache. The slowest
waits half once the cache is warm.
It starts in the source, as a
result.

9 (B4.2): "The digest copies it out, with its source." [click
on "The digest copies it out"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The digest copies it out, with where
it came from.

10 (B4.3): "In the outline, it is one beat with a time
budget." [click on "In the outline"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

In the outline, it's one beat with a time budget.

11 (B4.4): "In the script, it is the line the speaker must say." [click on "In the script"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

In the script, it's the line the speaker has to say.

12 (B4.5): "In the storyboard, it becomes a frame." [click on "In the storyboard"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

In the storyboard, it becomes a frame. A headline, the words that fire the click, and what's said while it's up.

13 (B4.6): "In the greybox, it is a page of rough boxes." [click on "In the greybox"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

In the greybox, it's a page of rough boxes.

14 (B4.7): "Each form is where one kind of mistake is cheapest to catch." [click on "Only then does anyone render it"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

Only then does anyone render it.
**Each form takes a minute to read,
 and each is where one kind of
 mistake is cheapest to catch.**

B5 ONE SOURCE FILE (3:00-3:40)

15 (B5.1): "The storyboard is the one source file." [click on "The storyboard is the one source file"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The storyboard is the one source file. The script and the deck are both made from it. Every click of the talk is one entry. Its headline, its trigger words, its narration. The script you rehearse is printed from it. The speaker notes come from it too.

16 (B5.2): "A scene must play exactly the clicks it lists." [click on "a scene has to play"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

And a scene has to play exactly the clicks it lists, or the build stops. So the words you rehearse are the words on screen.

B6 PEAK 2: A LATE NOTE GOES HOME (3:40-4:45)

17 (B6.1): "A late note goes back to the earliest stage it changes." [click on "A late note goes back"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

A late note goes back to the earliest stage it changes, and everything after it is rebuilt. Say a reviewer writes, slide seven, say halves, not forty-eight percent.

18 (B6.2): "Slide 7 is beat 3, frame 2 in the draft the reviewer saw." [click on "Slide seven is just the number"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

Slide seven is just the number on the screen. The agent looks up which frame that was, in the draft the reviewer saw. Beat three, frame two.

19 (B6.3): "The note is said back with its stage, and fixed there." [click on "Then it says the note back"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

Then it says the note back, with its stage. This one's a script note. The author confirms. The fix goes into the storyboard, not into the scene.

20 (B6.4): "Everything after it is rebuilt; only what changed is shown again." [click on "made again"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE

The script and the deck are made again, and only what changed comes back for a look. **The note lands where it belongs, so it costs a sentence again.**

ACT 3: USING IT

B7 USING IT (4:45-5:20)

21 (B7.1): "Clone it, write only in talk/, point any agent at AGENTS.md." [click on "Clone the repository"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE
Clone the repository, write only in the talk folder, and point any agent at the agents file. The instructions are plain text, so any coding agent can follow them.

22 (B7.2): "One command checks the machine; one builds the deck, offline." [click on "One command checks"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE
 One command checks your machine. One builds the deck, and it works offline. Your talk lives in one folder, so updates to the pipeline never touch it. And a shorter cut of the same talk keeps only what's different.

B8 PEAK 3: THIS SLIDE WAS A GREY BOX (5:20-6:00)

23 (B8.1): "This slide started as a grey box." [click on "This talk was made this way"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE
This talk was made this way. This slide started as a grey box.

24 (B8.2): "Every stage was checked before the next." [click on "Brief, digest, outline"]

MANIM-PRESENTATION-PIPELINE
 Brief, digest, outline, script, storyboard, greybox. Then the render. Each stage checked before the next. That's how a late note goes back to costing a sentence. **Build a talk the way you build software. In stages, each checked cheaply by its author, from one source file.**

BACKUP

S1 WHAT THE BUILD CHECKS

25 (S1.1): "The build checks every click for text over text." [for questions]

(On request: the layout lint runs at every click of the check pass.)

26 (S1.2): "And every seam between slides for a jump." [for questions]

(On request: the last frame of each slide against the first frame of the next.)